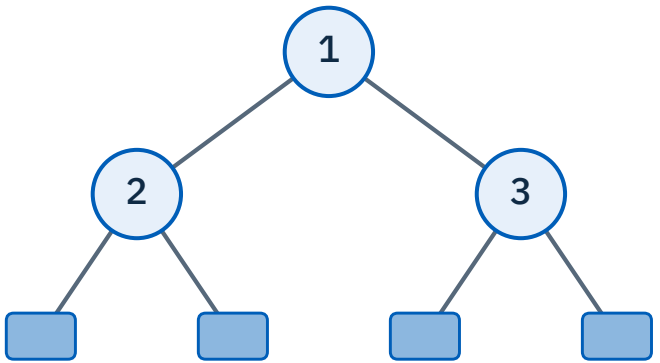
Level-wise (depth-wise)

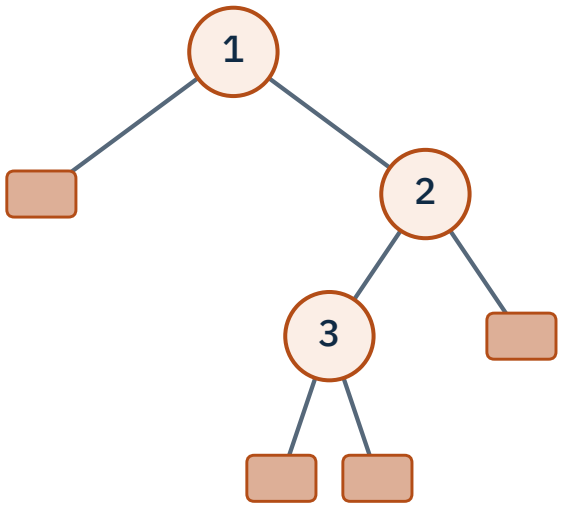
fills each level before going deeper



XGBoost default · limit: max_depth

Leaf-wise (best-first)

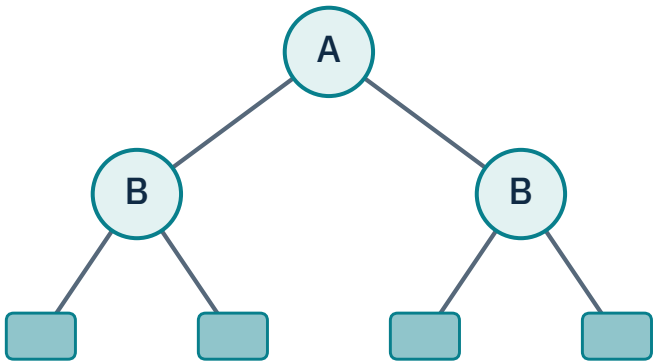
splits the leaf with the largest gain



LightGBM, sklearn HistGB · limit: leaves

Symmetric (oblivious)

one condition per level (A, then B)



CatBoost default · limit: depth